



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Barrington Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.bcacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit: Bethel Classical Academy**

Website used: <https://bethelclassical.org/>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly centers formation on truth, goodness, and beauty, integrates theology across disciplines, practices chapel/catechesis/Scripture memorization, employs the Trivium with Latin and integrated, chronologically taught history, and uses discussion, debate, logic, and rhetoric in the upper grades. Parent partnership and community worship are emphasized. Faculty claims highlight living the faith, though a fuller “portrait of a teacher” and collegial formation language are less explicit on the public site (suggesting room to strengthen Element 5 signals). Evidence is consistent with the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon.

Note on method: The keyword audit below uses positive/negative indicators from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (Religious Foundations; Purpose/Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents/Community) to quantify hits and coverage before assigning ratings.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS**1) Keywords found on the school's site (evidence)**

- Transcendentals/formation: “truth, goodness, and beauty,” “shape the hearts, minds, and souls,” “glorify God,” “biblical thinking.”
- Theology integrated: “Christ-centered Curriculum,” “biblical worldview,” knowledge is “interrelated... points back to Him [Christ].”
- Liturgical/communal: “weekly chapel,” “worship,” “hymns, creeds,” “catechisms,” “memorization of Scripture,” families gather.

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Christian worldview/theology; worship/chapel; hymnody; catechesis; Scripture; community worship.
- Negative indicators: None observed (no “values-neutral,” “relativism,” etc.).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: +12 (truth, goodness, beauty, biblical worldview, Christ-centered, worship, chapel, hymns, creeds, catechisms, Scripture memorization, community worship)
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (of sub-points: transcendental realism, theological grounding, liturgical/communal practice): 1.00

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- 1) Keywords found on the school's site (evidence)
 - Purpose/aim: "centered on truth, goodness, and beauty," "develop... virtue," "life-long love of learning," "live to glorify God," "shape the hearts, minds, and souls."
 - 2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon
 - Positive indicators matched: cultivation of virtue; formation (not mere information); pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful; telos oriented toward wisdom/character and God's glory.
 - Negative indicators: No "college-and-career-ready"/skills-first framing detected.
 - 3) Quantification
 - Positive hits: +7 (virtue, formation, truth/goodness/beauty, love of learning, biblical thinking/formation of soul, telos toward glorifying God)
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage (virtue/wisdom aim; formation; reality of transcendentals knowable): 0.90 (wisdom language less overt than virtue)
 - 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
-

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- 1) Keywords found on the school's site (evidence)
 - Liberal arts/Trivium: "Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric" with stage descriptions; Latin begins in first grade; formal logic and advanced rhetoric in high school.
 - Great Books/Western tradition: "Western Canon... engaged from a biblical worldview"; "complete literary works instead of textbooks comprised of literary excerpts."
 - History: "chronological historical study" and "great works and events of Western Civilization."
 - Integration: "Subjects are integrated across disciplines."
 - 2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon
 - Positive indicators matched: liberal arts/Trivium; Latin; great books/Western canon; primary/complete texts; integration across disciplines; chronological history (not "social studies").
 - Negative indicators: No prominence of "social studies," "STEM-first," or "project-based learning dominance."
 - 3) Quantification
 - Positive hits: +12 (Trivium, Latin, logic, rhetoric, Western Canon, great works, primary/complete texts, integration, chronology, debate/oratory, math/sciences within liberal framework, biblical worldview integration)
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage (Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/history; integration/wonder): 0.95 (Quadrivium term not explicit though math/science are present)
 - 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
-

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

- 1) Keywords found on the school's site (evidence)

- Middle/upper school methods: “discussion based,” focus on cause/effect; “introduced to debate” (informal logic in 7th), “formal logic” and “advanced rhetoric... persuasively communicate” in upper school.
- Memory/recitation: catechisms and Scripture memorization in community spiritual life (supports a culture of memorization).

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators matched: discussion/dialectic; debate and rhetoric; memory/recitation (catechesis/Scripture memorization).
- Positive indicators not explicitly observed on academics pages: Socratic seminar language; lower-school classroom “singing/chanting” of content; scholé/restfulness.
- Negative indicator present: “Academic Excellence and Rigor” language can signal less emphasis on scholé/restfulness if not balanced.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: +5 (discussion-based, debate, logic study, rhetoric training, memorization via catechism/Scripture)
- Negative hits: -1 (“Academic ... Rigor” as a potential tension with restfulness)
- Percent positive: 0.83
- Percent coverage (lower-school singing/chanting; wonder; upper-school Socratic/seminar/debate; rhetoric orations): 0.70 (clear debate/logic/rhetoric; less explicit on K–6 chanting and scholé)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: FACULTY

1) Keywords found on the school's site (evidence)

- Faculty as models: “Faculty that live out their faith and walk with Christ daily... members of local churches... believe in the inerrancy of the Bible and that God is Sovereign.”

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators matched: teachers modeling faith/virtue, moral formation by example.
- Less explicit: “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends/collegial culture,” ongoing classical formation for teachers.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: +3 (modeling faith, doctrinal alignment, moral formation implied)
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (model teachers; living curriculum; collegial/mentoring faculty; published teacher portrait): 0.50

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords found on the school's site (evidence)

- Parent partnership: “Parent Partnership” and “work together with parents as a community of faith.”
- Parent formation: curated booklist “Are you a parent who's considering classical Christian education? ... handpicked books.”
- Community worship: families gather for worship/chapel (hymns, creeds, Scripture).

2) Comparison with Six Elements lexicon

- Positive indicators matched: parent partnership/co-teachers; parent education; intentional community and liturgical life.
- Negative indicators: None noted (no “parent-as-customer only”).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: +5 (parent partnership, shared mission, community worship, parent resources/booklist, support for parents)
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Percent coverage (partnership; parent formation; hospitality/open access): 0.90 (open anytime not stated; “School Visit” CTA exists)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL

- Score rationale: 5 categories rated CLASSICAL, 1 category SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Faculty). The core of religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal, curriculum, pedagogy, and parent/community practices clearly align with the classical Christian model using the lexicon’s positive indicators. Faculty formation signaling could be more explicit publicly, but current evidence is consistent with a classical ethos.

Observations about absent or rare terms (for transparency) - Not found explicitly on academics pages: “Socratic”/“Socratic seminar,” “scholé” (restful learning), lower-school “chanting/singing” of content. Presence of “Academic Excellence and Rigor” could be balanced by public mention of rest/wonder/scholé to strengthen pedagogy signals. - Not found: “project-based learning,” “experiential learning,” “social studies” (the site consistently uses “history” and “chronological study,” a positive sign).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.